All this should not lead to any silly charges, against the mass of the Egyptian people, of indifference to the cause of the United Nations or of democracy. Their political indifference is much more profound. The mass of the Egyptian people know nothing of world politics. The "political class" of the country hardly includes 5 percent of the total population. Another 20 percent may be said, by courtesy, to be literate but derives no substantial economic advantage from this fact. Egypt, unlike Turkey, is a country of great extremes of wealth and poverty. In 1940 less than one-half of 1 percent of her landowners owned 37 percent of the land. Eighty percent of her people live, all of the time, under conditions of slow starvation. They are infected with parasitic diseases which stunt the growth of the body, often keep the mind from developing beyond that of a child, and produce general apathy and anemia. The chief parasitic diseases, bilharzia and ancylostomiasis, affect at least three-quarters of the population. There incidence is spreading with the extension of irrigation into Upper Egypt. Pellagra is very widespread. Trachoma and other serious eye diseases affect over nine-tenths of the population. A large part of the Egyptian masses today lives a life little removed from walking death.

Conditions are not radically different in the other Arab States. Modern industry has made only a feeble beginning. In no case is there a duplication of the extreme range from abject poverty to great wealth that exists in Egypt. However, with the exception of the Lebanon, no other Arab State contains a substantially broader "political class" than does Egypt. Monarchy is very strong. King Ibn Saud is an absolute monarch. King Farouk can break any Prime Minister and bring about the downfall of any party. The Emir Abdullah rules without any effective limits on his authority (except those of his British advisors). The King of Iraq, if he is a strong personality, can run the Iraqian Government as well as acting as Head of State. An independent Syria may also take the form of a monarchy, and if so it will be more than a Western "constitutional" monarchy. In all the Arab States which have ever had elections,